C1 vocabulary list

Every key word from the ten stories, grouped by story. Cover one column and test yourself.

1. El manifiesto de Almirante (The Almirante Manifest)

el muelle	dock, wharf
la nevera portátil	cold box, portable cooler
el manifiesto de carga	cargo manifest
la cadena de frío	cold chain (unbroken refrigeration from supplier to patient)
la bodega	hold (of a ship)
el aviso de tormenta	storm warning
el zarpe	departure clearance (Latin America: official permission for a vessel to sail)
el turno	shift (at work)
el estibador	stevedore, dock worker who loads and unloads ships
atracar	to berth, to tie up (of a ship)
la grúa	crane
tirar la toalla	to throw in the towel, to give up
la marea	tide
el taxi acuático	water taxi
el oleaje	swell, waves
zarpar	to set sail, to leave port
echarse a perder	to spoil, to go bad (of food, medicine)
el descargo	written statement in one's defence (in a disciplinary file)
la sanción	penalty, disciplinary sanction

2. Lo que silbó el barranco (What the Ravine Whistled)

el bancal	terrace (stepped plot of farmland on a slope)
el certamen	contest, competition
el barranco	ravine, gorge
el ahumado	smoked cheese (here); ahumado: smoked
la cabrera	(female) goat farmer, goatherd
la corteza	rind (of cheese); crust, bark
el rebaño	herd, flock

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no dar su brazo a torcer	to refuse to back down, to dig one's heels in
la cata	tasting (of food or wine)
la ladera	hillside, slope
el suero	whey (liquid left after curdling milk); also saline
el almogrote	Gomeran spread of aged goat cheese, garlic, pepper and oil
el mirador	viewpoint, lookout
el silbo	whistled language (silbo gomero)
la cuajada	curd(s)
ordeñar	to milk (an animal)
dar gato por liebre	to pass off something inferior as the real thing (lit. give cat for hare)
la descalificación	disqualification

3. El cacao de la promesa (The Promised Cacao)

el lote	lot, batch (of goods for sale)
el despacho	shipment, dispatch
la balanza	scales, weighing scale
la mazorca	cacao pod (also: ear of corn)
la caja de fermentación	fermentation box (wooden box where cacao beans ferment)
voltear	to turn over (cacao in the fermentation box)
la baba	sweet white pulp around fresh cacao beans
el chisme	piece of gossip, rumour
la prueba de corte	cut test (splitting beans to check fermentation)
madrugar	to get up very early, before dawn
el fogón	wood fire, open hearth for cooking
tostar	to roast (beans, coffee, cacao)
el pilón	large wooden mortar (for grinding)
el velorio	wake; in San Juan, the all-night vigil for the saint
la diferencia de peso	weight discrepancy
aplazar	to postpone, defer
la merma	shortfall, loss in quantity
la cláusula	clause (in a contract)

4. Cuatro centímetros y medio (Four and a Half Centimetres)

el calibrador	calliper (measuring instrument)

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la marea baja	low tide
el manglar	mangrove swamp, mangrove forest
el estero	estuary, tidal creek (in a mangrove)
la concha prieta	black cockle (Anadara tuberculosa), dug from mangrove mud
la talla mínima	minimum (legal) size
la tanda	batch, lot (of things done or collected at once)
el canasto	large basket
el fango	mud, mire
el raicero	tangle of mangrove roots (coastal Ecuador and Colombia)
vararse	to run aground
el intermediario	middleman
la camaronera	shrimp farm
la compuerta	sluice gate, floodgate
el sedimento	sediment, silt
talar	to cut down, fell (trees)
el aguaje	spring tide (coastal Ecuador)
el papelógrafo	flip chart (Andean countries)
el acta	minutes (of a meeting); takes el but is feminine: las actas

5. La voz de Triunfo (The Voice of Triunfo)

la cabina	(radio) booth, studio
la emisora comunitaria	community radio station
el transmisor	transmitter
la sentencia	(court) ruling, judgment
la cipota	girl, kid (Honduras, affectionate)
el carrete	reel (of tape)
el chisporroteo	crackle, sputter
el garaón	Garífuna drum (garaón ensemble: primero and segunda)
la cinta	(magnetic) tape
rebobinar	to rewind (rebobinaran: that they rewind)
el título colectivo	collective (land) title
el territorio ancestral	ancestral territory
el patrocinio	sponsorship

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la cuña	(radio) ad spot, short commercial
el pisto	money, cash (Honduras, colloquial)
el radiomaratón	radio-thon, fundraising broadcast
la parrilla de programación	programme schedule, line-up
la locución	(on-air) delivery, announcing
la machuca	Honduran name for hudutu: mashed plantain with fish in coconut broth
la punta	punta, Garífuna dance and music

6. La casa que cruzó el canal (The House That Crossed the Channel)

las tejuelas	wooden shingles (Chiloé)
la minga	collective work party (neighbours help, host feeds them)
el palafito	stilt house built over the water
la tiradura (de casa)	house-pulling: moving a house by oxen and boats
los tambores	(empty) barrels, drums used as floats
remolcar	to tow (remolcada: towed)
la yunta (de bueyes)	yoke, team (of oxen)
el plano regulador	zoning plan, land-use plan
terco	stubborn, pig-headed
el temporal	storm, spell of rough weather
la chalupa	small open fishing boat (Chiloé)
la muesca	notch, nick
el arrecife	reef
encallar	to run aground (encallaría: would run aground)
el calado	draught (depth of a vessel below the waterline)
la pleamar	high tide, high water
el curanto	curanto: shellfish, meat and potatoes cooked over hot stones in a pit
la escritura	(title) deed

7. La pregunta que faltaba (The Missing Question)

la tableta	tablet (computer)
la manzana	city block (Mexico; also 'apple')
el levantamiento	census enumeration, data collection (levantar el censo: to take the census)
el plazo	deadline, time limit

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la vivienda	dwelling, housing unit
el redondo	traditional round house with a conical thatched roof (Costa Chica)
la mecedora	rocking chair
la enramada	arbour, shelter roofed with branches or palm
la máscara	mask
el regazo	lap
la crin	mane, horsehair
afrodescendiente	Afro-descendant, of African descent
tallar	to carve (wood)
la Danza de los Diablos	Dance of the Devils (Afro-Mexican dance of the Costa Chica, around the Days of the Dead)
el informante	informant, respondent (the person who answers for a household)
el hogar	household (census unit); home
el cuestionario	questionnaire
la constancia	certificate, proof (here: sticker showing the census has been taken)

8. El real que no sonaba (The Coin That Rang False)

la exportación	export, exportation
la macuquina	irregular hand-struck colonial silver coin ('cob')
el anverso	obverse (front face of a coin)
el cuño	die (for striking coins); the stamped design
la lupa	magnifying glass, loupe
el aspa	X-shaped cross, saltire
la balanza de precisión	precision scale
la ley	fineness (proportion of precious metal in a coin); also 'law'
la aleación	alloy
fundir	to melt down, to cast (metal)
el acta	official record, report (levantar un acta: to draw up a report)
la ceca	mint (where coins are struck)
el ensayador	assayer (official who tests the metal content)
el visitador	royal inspector sent to investigate a colonial institution
el legajo	bundle of documents, file (in an archive)

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el canto	edge (of a coin)
el patrimonio	heritage (patrimonio cultural: cultural heritage)
la cartela	museum label, caption card

9. El cocinero de la goleta (The Schooner's Cook)

la cédula	individual entry or certificate (here: one person's record in the 1872 slave register)
el legajo	bundle of archive papers, file
la partida de bautismo	baptism certificate, baptismal record
el padrino	godfather
el liberto, la liberta	freedman, freedwoman (formerly enslaved person)
la Capitanía del Puerto	harbour master's office, port authority
el rol de tripulantes	crew list (official list of a ship's crew)
la goleta	schooner
el folio	leaf, page (of a ledger or file)
el asiento	entry (in a register or ledger)
el libro de entradas y salidas	register of ship arrivals and departures
el bergantín	brig (two-masted sailing ship)
la escala	port of call, stopover
la contrata	(work) contract, term of hire (old/formal)
el saldo	balance, outstanding amount owed
zarpar	to set sail, to weigh anchor
la tachadura	crossing-out, deletion

10. La torta negra de la señora Pugh (Mrs Pugh's Black Cake)

el testamento	will, testament
la escarcha	frost
el/la albacea	executor (of a will)
la cláusula	clause
legar	to leave, bequeath (in a will)
las pasas	raisins
el azúcar quemado	burnt sugar, dark caramel
el horno	oven
la sucesión	estate; succession (inheritance proceedings)
el heredero, la heredera	heir
el cuaderno de recetas	recipe notebook

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la capilla	chapel (in Welsh Patagonia, the Welsh nonconformist chapel)
la cáscara de naranja confitada	candied orange peel
colorado	red, red-faced (ponerse colorado: to blush)
el escribano, la escribana	notary (Argentina, Uruguay)
la lapicera	pen (Argentina)
la firma	signature; signing

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